

cw2 con'26

Who are we ?



Raphiki

QSOS Methodology Creator



Genma

Opensource Evangelist

Agenda

1. From 20 years ago to now 
2. Quick Presentation of the Method 
3. Adoption and Use in a Professional Context 
4. Reboot & Quick Demo 
5. Conclusion 

Section 1: From 20 years ago to now 



The Challenge of Choosing Open Source Software

- **Growing Core Competency:** Integrating software (open or closed source) into an information system requires deep strategic, technical, and functional analysis.
- **Risk assessment:** Traditional assessment methods fail to account for the unique ecosystem dynamics of Free/Libre Open Source Software (FLOSS).
- **How to make educated choices:** Because the open-source domain is so vast, multiple software components often match the same functional need.

> QSOS was built to provide a formalized, structured methodology to differentiate, qualify, and compare OSS choices in an objective and contextualized manner.

Driving Objectivity through Openness 1/2

- **Drink your own champagne:** To promote and support the Free/Open Source software ecosystem, the tool and method evaluating it must embody the exact same values.
- **Enabling Reuse:** Releasing the framework under **an open license** guarantees that **anyone can reuse, adapt, and build upon existing software evaluations rather than starting from scratch**.
- **Ensuring Quality and Objectivity:**
  - Closed evaluation methods hide their bias.
  - An open-source methodology ensures complete transparency.
  - Evaluation documents are perfected and validated via peer review from the community.

Driving Objectivity through Openness 2/2

> You shouldn't use a secret, proprietary box to judge open-source technology. The community validation of the evaluation is what makes the final score trustworthy.

QSOS applied to QSOS: A Look in the Mirror

- **Strong Architectural Foundation:** From day one, QSOS was smartly designed to separate the core methodology from specific document formats and tooling.
- **Community Paradox:** While the project achieved widespread adoption by diverse stakeholders, it failed to foster a vibrant, self-sustaining contributing community.
- **Diagnosis:** Applying the QSOS maturity criteria directly to the QSOS project itself would have flagged critical risks: dependency from a single vendor, tooling obsolescence.
- **Timeless Value:** Despite aging tools, the underlying methodology remains highly valid and actively used, though it now requires a strategic refresh to address the realities of Cloud and AI.

> The reboot isn't a rescue mission for a broken idea; it’s an upgrade to align a proven framework with modern AI/Cloud ecosystems and open-source

Section 2: Quick Presentation of the Method



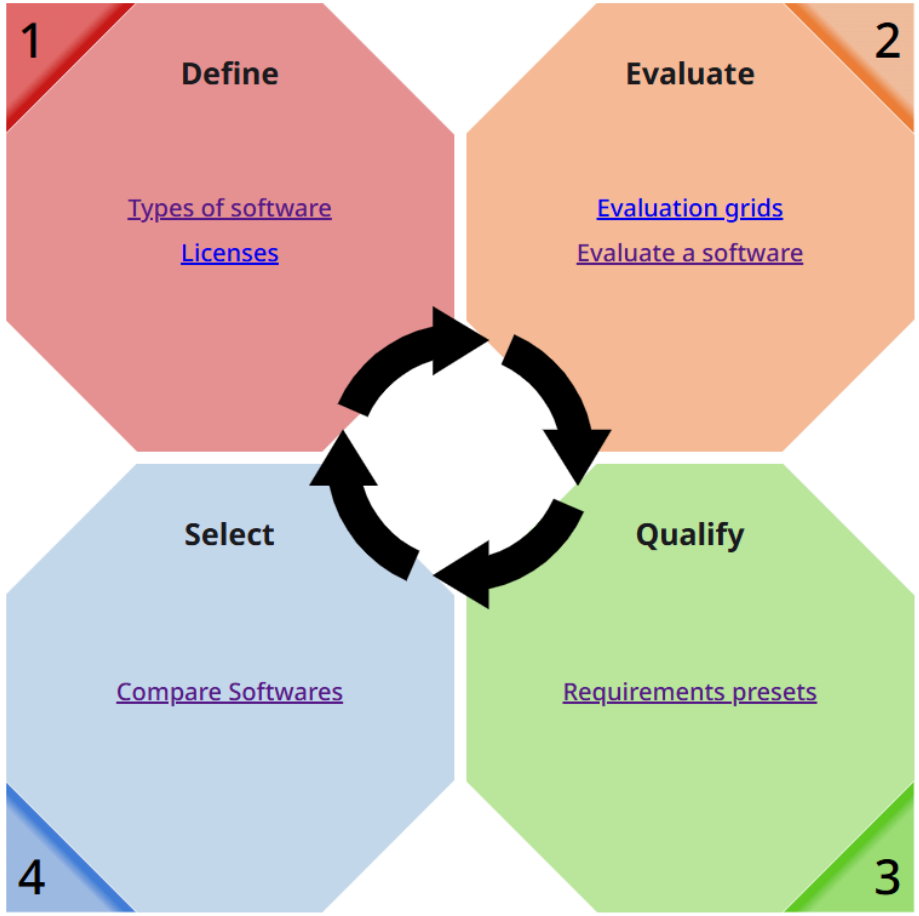
What was and what is QSOS?

- **Definition:** **Q**ualification and **S**election of **O**pen **S**ource **S**oftware (QSOS) is a **comprehensive, open methodology** for assessing and selecting Free/Libre Open Source Software (FLOSS).
- **License:** Methodology released under GFDL (GNU Free Documentation License).
- **Tools:** Accompanying tools distributed under GPL (e.g., O3S for evaluation and comparison).
- **Goal:** Help organizations objectively evaluate, compare, and select the best open-source solutions for their needs.

The 4-Step Iterative Process

Be sure to make the right choice

QSOS is a comprehensive method designed to help you effectively evaluate and select the best open source software for your projects.



Pool the effort

QSOS is also a collaborative project aimed at pooling and capitalizing on technological monitoring of open source components and projects.

The 4-Step Iterative Process 1/2

1. **Define & Organize**
    - Identify software families, licenses, and communities to assess.
    - Establish common open-source criteria (maturity, technical, functional) and domain-specific requirements.
2. **Evaluate**
    - Score software against predefined criteria (0 to 2 scale).
    - Cover functionality, user risks, and provider risks.

The 4-Step Iterative Process 2/2

1. **Qualify**
    - Organize criteria into evaluation axes.
    - Apply weightings based on context, user needs, and strategy.
2. **Select**
    - Filter and compare software using the weighted scoring system.
    - Identify the most relevant solutions for your project.

> ✅ Iterative: Process can be refined and repeated for deeper analysis.

QSOS Full vs. QSOS Lite

Feature	QSOS Full	QSOS Lite
Scope	Comprehensive (maturity + technical + functional)	Focused on **maturity criteria** only
Depth	Detailed, multi-axis evaluation	Simplified, fast-track assessment
Use Case	Strategic decisions, complex projects	Quick identification of viable options
Time Investment	Higher (detailed analysis)	Lower (rapid screening)
Ideal For	Enterprises, critical systems	SMEs, preliminary evaluations

Evaluation Axes & Criteria 1/2

Core Axes (QSOS Full)

1. Maturity

- Project age, release frequency, community size.
- Example: "Is the project actively maintained?"

2. Technical

- Architecture, scalability, performance, security.
- Example: "Does it support our required integrations?"

Evaluation Axes & Criteria 2/2

3. Functional

- Feature coverage, usability, customization.
- Example: "Does it meet 80% of our functional needs?"

4. Risks (User & Provider Perspective)

- Legal risks (licensing), support availability, expertise.
- Example: "Are there commercial support options?"

> - Customizable: Criteria can be weighted based on organizational priorities.

Section 3: Adoption and Use in a Professional Context



Why Adopt QSOS in a Professional Setting?

Challenges QSOS Addresses

❌ **Overwhelming choices:** Thousands of open-source projects → How to pick the right one?
❌ **Hidden risks:** Licensing, support, or maturity issues → How to mitigate them?
❌ **Subjective decisions:** Biases or lack of structure → How to standardize evaluations?
❌ **Resource constraints:** Limited time/budget for evaluation → How to optimize the process?

> QSOS provides a structured, repeatable, and transparent framework.

Key Benefits for Organizations 1/2

Strategic Advantages

✅ Objective Decision-Making

- Reduces bias with weighted, scored criteria.

✅ Risk Mitigation

- Identifies legal, technical, and operational risks early.

✅ Cost Efficiency

- Avoids costly mistakes (e.g., adopting unsupported software).

Key Benefits for Organizations 1/2

✅ **Time Savings**

- QSOS Lite enables rapid shortlisting of candidates.

✅ **Collaboration**

- Shared templates and evaluation data across teams.

✅ **Compliance**

- Ensures alignment with internal policies and regulatory requirements.

Professional Use Cases 1/2

Where QSOS Fits in Business Processes

1. **Software Procurement**
    - Evaluate open-source alternatives to commercial tools (e.g., databases, CRM).
2. **Digital Transformation**
    - Select scalable, maintainable solutions for long-term projects.
3. **Vendor Lock-in Avoidance**
    - Assess open-source options to reduce dependency on proprietary software.

Professional Use Cases 2/2

1. **Mergers & Acquisitions**
    - Audit open-source components in target companies' tech stacks.
2. **Innovation & R&D**
    - Identify emerging open-source technologies for competitive advantage.

Success Stories & Industry Adoption

- **Atos:** Originator of QSOS; used for enterprise-grade evaluations.
- **Public Sector:** Adopted by government agencies / French Ministeries for transparent, accountable software selection. https://gitlab.adullact.net/marche-sll/etudes-de-veille-2025-2028

Section 4: Reboot & Quick Demo



Reboot Strategy: Focus on Usage & Community

The Blueprint for the QSOS Renaissance

- **Community-First Governance:** Anchoring the project in an open ecosystem from day one with explicit, proven governance, leading us naturally to the Eclipse Foundation.
- **A Shift to Usage-Centricity:** The original tooling was too engineering-focused.

- **Unified Web App**: We are replacing scattered tools with a single, modern, and portable Web Application.
- **Rock-Solid Standards over "Geek Choices":** No obscure or short-lived tech stacks (XUL memories!). We are sticking to ubiquitous, modern standards like TypeScript.
- **Architectural Simplicity:** Designing for maximum portability and zero deployment friction by avoiding databases wherever possible.

> This reboot is a shift from a technical asset to a product and community. By choosing the Eclipse Foundation, we solve the historical community issue

Quick Demo

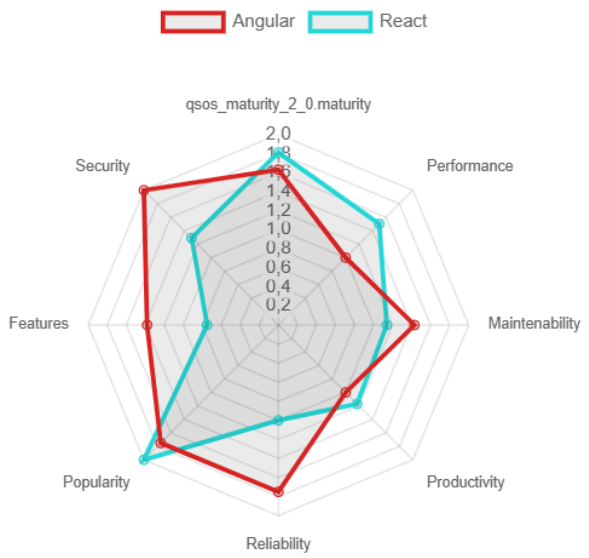
Compare Web frameworks

Grid version 1.7

Export PDF

Radar Bubble

Criteria	Weight Preset: 10 Save Weights	Angular 1 evaluation	React 1 evaluation
Computed Score		**1.52**	**1.49**
Maturity	590 %	1.63	1.81
Legacy	100 %	2.00	1.75
Age	100 %	2.00	2.00
History	100 %	2.00	1.00
Core team	100 %	2.00	2.00
Popularity	100 %	2.00	2.00
Activity	100 %	1.50	2.00
Contributing community	100 %	1.00	2.00
Activity on bugs	100 %	1.00	2.00
Activity on functionalities	100 %	2.00	2.00



Section 5: Conclusion



Key Takeaways

- QSOS is a structured, open methodology for evaluating and selecting open-source software.
- It combines maturity, technical, functional, and risk assessments in a 4-step iterative process.
- QSOS Full for deep analysis, QSOS Lite for rapid screening.
- Professional adoption drives objectivity, risk reduction, and cost savings.

The Roadmap Ahead 1/2

Charting the Future of Open Source Evaluation

- **Modernizing the Core:** Upgrading the maturity matrix to directly address today's architectural challenges and engineering risks.
- **Embracing the AI Era:**
  - Establishing clear AI governance for the project itself.
  - Investigating how GenAI can augment and accelerate the QSOS evaluation lifecycle (QSOS Agent/MCP Server/Skills…).

The Roadmap Ahead 2/2

- **Automated Metrics Collection:** Shifting from manual updates to (semi) automated data collection, a goal heavily accelerated by joining the **Eclipse Foundation ecosystem!**.
- **A shared Vision:** These milestones are not set in stone; they are foundational elements of a vision to be discussed, refined, and co-created with the community.

> It’s our initial compass to reboot a framework that scales. The final destination will be shaped entirely by the community we are building.

Thank you! Any questions?